

January 17, 2026

Rodney McGraw				
Western Michigan				
Edge Rusher				
Height: 6060	Weight: 265	Year: 5SR	Jersey #: 4	Hometown: Chicago, IL
Games Reviewed: 2025 Illinois, Eastern Michigan, Miami OH, Kennesaw State				
2025 Stats:				
Career Stats:				
Scouting Report by: Danny Nolan				

<u>Critical Factors</u>					
Pass Rush Ability		1st Step Explosion		POA/Set Edge	
5		6		4	
<u>Positional Factors</u>					
PR Repertoire	Bend	Hand Use	Play Strength	Range	Flat Coverage
4	4	4	4	5	3
Motor	FBI	Discipline	Tackling	Toughness	ST Value
6	4	5	6	6	5

Strengths

- Burst
- Physicality
- Versatility

Weaknesses

- Acting as a run-stuffer
- Setting the edge
- Recognizing play fakes

Overall

Rodney McGraw is a senior EDGE in Western Michigan's even-front defense. While he's always on the ball, McGraw lines up in all sorts of ways for the Broncos, from nose tackle to outside linebacker and everything in between. His physical gifts afford him this luxury, as he pairs the size of a defensive tackle with the athleticism of an edge rusher. Western Michigan has been McGraw's third stop in his journey as a collegiate athlete. He spent two years at Penn State, appearing in five games after a redshirt season, then transferred to Louisville for a year and played one game as a Cardinal. He has been at Western Michigan for the past two years, playing in 27 total games. McGraw's style of play backs up his intimidating stature, as he has a high work rate and never shies away from a tackle.

Pass Game

In the pass game, McGraw looks most comfortable in a two-point stance. This best allows him to showcase his first-step quickness and results in an initial penetration at the line of scrimmage. However, McGraw often stalls out after that burst, for he lacks a polished pass rush repertoire. His best move is a simple bull rush. He'll look dominant on occasion, but the best tackles will shut that down. His speed-to-power rush is the other weapon in his limited arsenal. As the season progressed, his hand use improved, and he was able to put some serviceable swim moves and swipes on tape. At 6'6", McGraw lacks bend in his game. He's much more likely to bat a pass than scrape the grass getting around the edge. Since he functioned as a DL/EDGE hybrid with the Broncos, he wasn't asked to drop into coverage as much as a typical EDGE. When he did, he wasn't a liability but hardly looked comfortable as a zone defender. Despite plus speed for his size, McGraw would be outmatched in man coverage.

Run Game

On the ground, McGraw's athleticism becomes less important, and his shortcomings as a technician are thrust under the microscope. When he lines up inside, he is swallowed up by a strong interior offensive lineman, since he is smaller than a true DT. On the edge, McGraw fares slightly better, but his inability to shed blocks from tackles and tight ends is disappointing. He often does well to set up a 2-gap situation, but he can't always shed when the time comes. If he does get off his block, McGraw makes his presence felt. He is an apt tackler, and he does a nice job corralling ball carriers when attached to a blocker. He has more success than most at completing arm tackles. It's clear that McGraw relishes that part of the job, as he's always willing to stick his nose into a pileup. McGraw has sufficient discipline, but his play recognition needs improvement. He bites on play fakes too frequently, and a read option or RPO-heavy offense could give him fits.

Last Word

McGraw's build has its pros and cons, and it sets him up as somewhat of a tweener at the next level. Due to his troubles as a run-stuffer, he projects best as an 4-3 EDGE in the NFL. 3rd down might be where he sees most of his usage, as teams could then slide him inside to

bolster the pass rush. He would be a big body on special teams, but his length and toughness suggest that he might have value in such a role.

One-Liner: McGraw's tantalizing physicality and versatility will give him a chance to succeed, but they cannot completely cover up his lack of polish and awkward fit on an NFL field.

Grade: 5.7 - Ceiling: 6.5 (5%) Floor: 5.4 (20%) Round: UDFA